

01 - Brand Identity Playbook

Brand identity playbook | Visual identity system and usage rules

Formal name: Brand identity playbook

Strategic role

The website is the narrative layer that connects LinkedIn, Substack, and GitHub. It should feel like a personal authority site for an AI-fluent product marketer who connects strategy, technology, culture, and practical experimentation.

Positioning anchor

- I explore how AI, product marketing, and culture shape the future of go-to-market work.
- I write, build small AI experiments, and translate complex technology into stories people can understand and use.

Palette: Option 3 / Wayfinder Blue

Token	Hex	Role	Usage rule
Moonstone Paper	#F4F5F8	Base background	Default canvas. Do not use pure white except small surfaces.
Harbor Ink	#243246	Primary text	Headlines, nav, body. Avoid black.
Silver Fog	#D9DFE8	Cards / quiet panels	Low-emphasis containers and page bands.
Blueprint Blue	#5868F2	Primary CTA / active state	Use sparingly. One main CTA per view.
Steel Slate	#7087A0	Metadata / dividers	Secondary UI only.
Deep Fjord	#2F5D76	Depth / project accents	Adds maturity to tech moments.
Soft Iris	#8B78B8	Annotations / North voice	Human handwritten layer, never the main body color.

Typography system

Use	Recommended font	Fallback	Notes
Display headlines	Fraunces or Cormorant Garamond	Georgia	Elegant editorial tone. Use large sizes and generous line-height.
Body / UI	Inter or Source Sans 3	Aptos / Arial	Readable, modern, low friction.
Code / labels	IBM Plex Mono	Consolas	Only for project metadata, tags, code labels, and tiny system notes.
Handwritten accents	A lightweight script or custom SVG lettering	Manual SVG/text image	Use only for North notes and annotation marks.

Mascot / theme

Theme: The Wayfinder. Companion name: North. North is not a cartoon mascot; it is a subtle editorial companion that helps readers navigate the ideas, projects, and cultural signals behind the work.

- Core marks: compass rose, contour lines, sprig/leaf, dotted route, bracket/underline annotation.
- Personality: calm, curious, useful, reflective, never goofy.
- Role: call out signal, provide context, and connect writing to projects and playlists.
- Never use North as a chatbot, robot, animal mascot, or loud character that competes with the work.

Visual language rules

- Use spacious editorial layouts, not dense SaaS dashboards.
- Every card must answer: what does this prove about Darwin?
- Use subtle blue and iris annotations to create warmth and memory.
- Avoid generic stock photos. Prefer line art, project screenshots, simple album/playlist thumbnails, or abstract placeholders.
- CTAs should be direct: Read on Substack, View on GitHub, Open on Spotify, Get in touch.

Brand Direction

Darwin Hernandez

AI-FLUENT PRODUCT MARKETER & WRITER

I write at the intersection of AI, product, and culture—
turning signal into strategy and complexity into clarity.

Warm intelligence
Practical experimentation
Cultural taste
Editorial, not corporate

1. COLOR PALETTE



2. TYPOGRAPHY

HEADLINES
(Serif)

Curiosity is a strategy.

Fraunces or
Cormorant Garamond
style serif

SUBHEADLINE
(Serif)

Exploring how AI changes what we build,
how we work, and what matters next.

BODY / UI
(Sans)

I write about product strategy, GTM, and the real-world
implications of AI. Notes from experiments, reads, and
conversations that shape how I think.

Inter or Source Sans 3
style clean sans

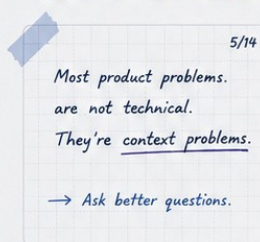
CODE / LABELS
(Mono)

```
$ ship_thoughts == true // iterate, learn, share
```

IBM Plex Mono
style mono

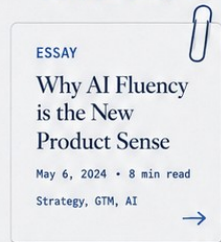
3. GRAPHIC IDENTITY

ANNOTATED FIELD NOTEBOOK



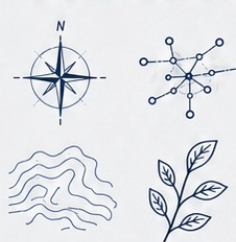
Handwritten notes, dates, highlights,
and callouts create a personal,
reflective tone.

EDITORIAL CARDS

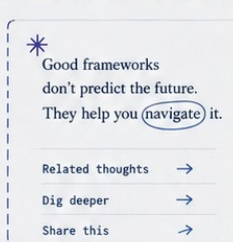


Clean cards for essays and notes.
Clear hierarchy, breathing room,
so ideas take center stage.

SUBTLE LINE ILLUSTRATIONS



MARGIN NOTES & UI CUES



Margin notes, underlines, brackets,
and subtle cues guide attention
like a well-worn notebook.

Reference brand-board direction generated during discovery.